Cause, effect and purpose

Objective: To link ideas logically by expressing cause, effect and purpose with the right connectors, especially when writing about waste and its consequences.

The idea in two lines: A **cause** answers "why?", an **effect** answers "what is the result?", and a **purpose** answers "what for?". Each relation has its own connectors, and each connector has its own grammar.

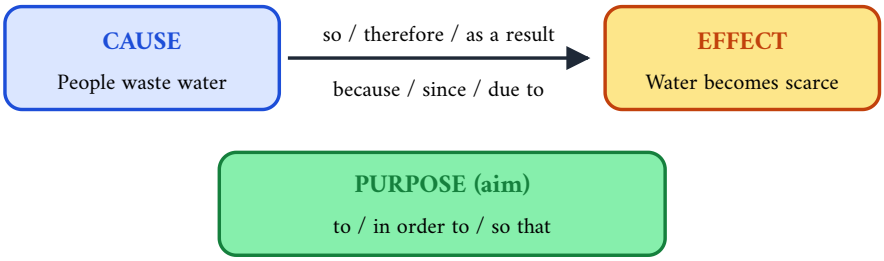


Figure 1: Cause leads to effect; purpose expresses the aim of an action.

🔵 Rules and concepts

1. **Cause + clause:** because, as, since: *Rivers are polluted because factories dump waste.*
2. **Cause + noun / -ing:** because of, due to, owing to: *due to pollution.*
3. **Effect:** so, therefore, consequently, as a result: *We waste food; as a result, landfills grow.*
4. **So ... that / such ... that:** *so* + adjective, *such* + (a) noun: *It was so dirty that nobody swam.*
5. **Purpose + base form:** to, in order to, so as to (negative: *in order not to*).
6. **Purpose + clause:** so that + subject + can / could / will: *We sort waste so that it can be recycled.*

🟢 Examples

1. Join with *due to*: "Many fish died. The water was polluted." **Answer:** Many fish died *due to* water pollution. **Explanation:** due to is followed by a noun phrase.
2. Join with *therefore*: "Plastic does not decompose quickly. We should use less of it." **Answer:** Plastic does not decompose quickly; *therefore*, we should use less of it.
3. Express purpose: "We reuse bags. We want to protect nature." **Answer:** We reuse bags *in order to* protect nature.

🟠 Common BAC mistakes

- Putting a clause after **because of**: *because of the water is dirty* ×.
- Writing *for to protect* × instead of **to / in order to protect**.
- Mixing cause and effect: the connector must point in the right direction.
- Confusing **so** (+ adjective) and **such** (+ noun).

🟡 Quick review

- because / as / since + clause.
- because of / due to + noun.
- so / therefore / as a result = effect.
- to / in order to + verb; so that + clause = purpose.

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